THE MARITIME SAFETY COMMIITEE , RECALLING Aniele 28(b) of the Convention on the Internati onal Maritime Organization concerning the functions of the Committee, RECALLING FURTHER article XII of the International Convention on Standards of Training, Certification and Watchkeeping for Seafarers (STeW) , 1978, hereinafter referred to as "the Convention", concerning the procedures for amending the Convention , HAVING CONS IDERED resolution 6 of the 1995 Confere nce of Parties to the] 978 STeW Convention and relevant provisions addressing the training of masters, officers, ratings and other personnel serving on passenger ships. HAVING ALSO CONSIDERE D, at its sixty-eighth session, amendments to regulations V /2 and - Convention and relevant provisions addressing the training of masters, officers, ratings and other personnel serving on passenger ships. HAVING ALSO CONSIDERE D, at its sixty-eighth session, amendments to regulations V /2 and V!3 of the Convention proposed and circulated in accordance Wlth article XII(l)(a)(i) thereof, 1. ADOPTS, in accordance with article XII(I)(a)(iv) of the Convention, amendments to the Convention, the text of which is set out in the Annex to the present resolution; 2. DETERMINES, in accordance with article XD(t)(a)(vii)2 of the Convention, that the amendments shall be deemed to have been accepted 011 I JuJy 1998, WI1ess, prior to tba tdate, more than one third of Parties or Parties me combined merchant fleets of which constitute not less than 50% of the gross tOIUlage of the world'smerchant shipping of ships of 1 00 gross register tons or more , have notified their objecuons to the amendments ; 3. INVITES Parties to the STCW Convention to note that, in accordance with article XII(l)(a)(ix) of the Convention, the amendments shall enter into force on 1 January 1999 upon their acceptance in accord ance with paragrapb 2 above; - 3. INVITES Parties to the STCW Convention to note that, in accordance with article XII(l)(a)(ix) of the Convention, the amendments shall enter into force on 1 January 1999 upon their acceptance in accord ance with paragrapb 2 above; 4. REQUESTS the Secretary·General , in conformity with article XII())(a)(v) oftbe Convention, to transmit certified copies of the present resolution and the text of the amendments contained in the Annex to all Parties to the ConventlOn; 5. FURTIIER REQUESTS the Secretary-General to transmit copies of this resolution and its Annex to Members of the Organization which are not Parties to the Convention. RESOLUTION MSC.66(68) (adopted on 4 June 1997) ADOPTION OF AMENDMENTS TO THE INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION ON STANDARDS OF TRAINING, CERTIFICATION AND WATCHKEEPING FOR SEAFARERS, 1978, AS AMENDED-2- ANNEX AMENDMENTS TO THE INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION ON STANDARDS OF TRAINING, CERTIFICATION AND WATCHKEEPING FOR SEAF